

MICHAEL P. RAGSDALE

Software Architect | Full-Stack PHP Developer

Cloud Infrastructure • Accessibility Engineering • Open-Source Platform Development
Norfolk, VA | U.S. Citizen (Clearance Eligible) | 757-289-1609 |
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Professional Summary

Software Architect and Full-Stack PHP Developer specializing in custom web platforms, accessibility-first application architecture, cloud infrastructure, and open-source software development. Creator of the Stardust Engine CMS, a zero-database PHP framework featuring JSON-driven routing, custom SPA navigation, and AI-assisted development workflows. Experienced across the full software lifecycle, including architecture, development, cloud deployment, DNS management, CI/CD automation, and production operations.

Technical Skills

- Languages: PHP 8.x, JavaScript (ES6+), Python, Bash, SQL, HTML5, CSS3
- Architecture: MVC Frameworks, JSON Routing, SPA Applications, REST APIs
- Infrastructure: Ubuntu Linux, Nginx, DigitalOcean, Cloudflare, Git, CI/CD
- Accessibility: WCAG 2.1 AA, Section 508, Deque axe
- AI & Automation: Gemini, LLM Workflows, AI Development Governance

Relevant Technical Experience

Principal Systems Architect & Founder RaggieSoft Media | Norfolk, VA | Est. 2008 – Present

Founded and operate RaggieSoft Media, an independent software development and digital publishing ecosystem supporting web applications, cloud infrastructure, music distribution, narrative publishing, accessibility-first development, and open-source software.

- Architected and open-sourced **Stardust Engine CMS**, a custom PHP MVC platform utilizing a zero-database JSON architecture, native PHP processing, and a custom Vanilla JavaScript SPA routing engine.
- Designed and maintain cloud infrastructure utilizing DigitalOcean, Nginx, Cloudflare DNS, SSL services, and automated deployment workflows.
- Architected Elara, a custom PHP Front Controller and Vanilla JavaScript SPA routing layer responsible for JSON-driven route discovery, request dispatching, and dynamic content rendering.
- Developed Bash automation pipelines for media processing, repository validation, deployment automation, and content publishing.
- Administer multiple public-facing digital properties, including software, music, publishing, and e-commerce initiatives operating under the RaggySoft Media umbrella.
- Created AI-development governance documentation, architectural constraints, and repository guidance to support maintainable AI-assisted software development workflows.
- Enforce WCAG 2.1 AA and Section 508 accessibility principles throughout platform architecture and content delivery workflows.

Clerk-Cashier City of Virginia Beach Parks & Recreation | Virginia Beach, VA | May 2023 – Present

- **Data Engineering & ETL Pipelines:** Architect and manage manual ETL (Extract-Transform-Load) pipelines to ingest, normalize, and secure complex operational and financial data from legacy enterprise platforms (ActiveNet) into highly accessible digital formats.
- **Player-Coach Leadership & Training:** Serve as the primary technical trainer and operational escalation point for municipal staff, translating complex data integrity protocols and Revenue Cycle Management (RCM) compliance into actionable training programs.
- **Stakeholder & Governance Management:** Partner with facility leadership to optimize resource allocation, resolving complex logistical conflicts through data-driven insights and strict adherence to municipal policy.
- **Compliance Enforcement:** Govern output data to guarantee strict Section 508 compliance across all generated operational documents from legacy systems, ensuring institutional adherence to federal accessibility mandates.

Computer Operations Old Dominion University (ODU Online) | Norfolk, VA | Nov 2019 – Jul 2022

- **Enterprise Accessibility Strategy:** Served as the primary technical gatekeeper for enterprise-level data and web content during a massive, university-wide digital infrastructure migration to the Canvas LMS.
- **Compliance Auditing:** Executed rigorous WCAG 2.1 AA and Section 508 compliance audits, remediating complex codebases (HTML/CSS) and ensuring strict structural integrity across institutional platforms using tools like Deque axe.
- **Architectural Standardization:** Engineered universal, inherently accessible data/architectural templates deployed across the university ecosystem, heavily streamlining data-entry workflows for instructional design faculty.

Mobile Applications Developer Intern Dominion Enterprises | Norfolk, VA | Sep 2012 – Dec 2012

- Engineered cross-platform mobile applications for iOS and Android utilizing the JavaScript-based Titanium SDK.
- Gained foundational, hands-on experience in mobile architecture and deployment, establishing a decade-long trajectory in software engineering.

Education & Certification

- **Tidewater Community College** | Virginia Beach, VA Associate of Science, Information Technology (Focus: Software Engineering & Web Dev) | Expected Dec 2026
- **Old Dominion University** | Norfolk, VA Bachelor of Science, Customized Studies in Leadership | Prior Coursework
- **Wilson Workforce and Rehabilitation Center (formerly Woodrow Wilson Rehabilitation Center)** | Fishersville, VA Certificate, Business & Information Technology | 2011